



CHIRUNDU TOWN COUNCIL



GRIEVANCE REDRESS MECHANISM 2024-2025

VISION CONTROL

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GRIEVANCE REDNESS MECHANISM

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1. INTRODUCTION

This document describes the Grievance Redress Mechanism for Chirundu Town Council (hereafter referred to as "Employers"), outlining the procedures to address any comments, Suggestions, questions and complaints that workers as well as key stakeholders may have about the organization particularly Chirundu Town Council Activities. This Grievance Redress Mechanism has been developed in line with the Zambian Labour Laws. A grievance Mechanism is a procedure that provides a clear and transparent way for employees to address complaints in a workplace.

PURPOSE OF THE GRIEVANCE MECHANISM

A Grievance Mechanism should be legitimate, accessible, predictable, equitable, transparent, right – compatible, and based on dialogue and engagement for both employees and stakeholders

If the grievance submitted is determined to be eligible, a process is then followed to identify the root cause of the grievance and make sure the issue or rather the problem of non- compliance with the terms and conditions are rectified. Some grievance cases may require remedial measures to redress potential harm resulting from failure to follow conditions of service provisions and preventive measures to avoid repetition of non- compliance.

Particularly this grievance redress Mechanism aims at:

- Giving Chirundu Town Council guild to address Complaints, Comments, questions, concerns and suggestions from projects, the Community and the Key Stakeholders, related to the council and its activities in fair and transparent ways.
- Identify and manage stakeholders concerns and support effective risk Management.
- Provide stakeholders fearing adverse impact from the operations with the assurance that they will be heard and assisted in time.
- Build and maintain trust with all stakeholders thereby creating an enabling environment in which to operate.
- Prevent by all means adverse consequences of failure to adequately address grievances

As such the grievance redress Mechanism does not intend to substitute for any existing grievance procedure established by Cabinet office by it should be complementary on existing procedures. Identify, register and respond to them appropriately. Chirundu Town Council Grievance redress Mechanism operates under steps;

GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE

The grievance procedure resolution comprises of six stages, in order to be practical and cost effective, resolution of complaints should be sought at the lowest possible level. This procedure aims to address stakeholders/ employees concerns promptly, effectively and transparently.

Grievance communication channels

Channel	Contact details	responsible
Verbally person(in		
In writing		

- a. Grievance is formally acknowledge through a personal meeting or letter as appropriate, within working days. If the grievance is not well understood or if additional information is required, clarification should be sought from the complainant during this step.
- b. A response is developed by the responsible staff with input from others, as necessary. This includes working with existing mechanisms (including terms and Condition of Service and dispute settlements mechanism such as Grievance handling procedure, this includes staff, Local authorities and traditional leaders/ Community representative.
- c. Required actions implanted to deal with the issue, and completion of these, is recorded in the grievance register.
- d. The response is signed – off by the responsible staff. The sign –off may be a signature on the grievance register or in correspondence that should be filled with the grievance to indicate agreement.

- e. The response is communicated to the affected party; the response should be carefully coordinated. The responsible staff ensures that a suitable approach to communicating the response to the affected party is agreed and implemented. The response to the grievance will be provided 20 working days after receipt of the grievance.
- f. The response of the complainant is recorded to help assess whether the grievance is closed or whether further action is needed. The responsible staff use appropriate communication channels to confirm whether the complainant's response is recorded in the Grievance register. Ideally both parties sign off the grievance to confirm closure.
- g. The grievance is closed with sign-off from the responsible staff, who determines whether the grievance can be closed or whether further attention and action is required.

Chirundu Town Council has a grievance redress mechanism which is effective, legitimate, accessible, predictable, equitable, transparent, rights-compatible and based on dialogue and engagement.

MAINTAIN RECORDS

- All grievances, whether eligible or not, is recorded and kept on appropriate files
- Reporting on grievances management to relevant committees is done quarterly.
- The register document contains all complaints, suggestions, comments, questions submitted to stakeholders in a categorical way the following headings;
 1. Grievance register: including subject of complaints and description of complaints
 2. Acknowledgement: staff acknowledgement receipt of grievance within working days.
 3. Investigation of eligible grievance only) Human Resource Section investigates the root cause. Whether the claim is true or false and propose a corrective action to be taken.
 4. Responses: staff provide a response to the complainant ; and
 5. Close out: the principle officer closes the grievance once it has been adequately addressed and remedied and a response provided to the complainant.

CONCLUSION

Accessibility of the complaint submission, handling and recording is designed in such a way that staff and stakeholders have confidence in the mechanism and that procedures are in place to protect complaints from any form of avenging action, including provisions for disciplinary or other appropriate action in case of violations of condition of service.